

Sharp Identification Regions in General Selection Models with (Un)ordered Treatments and Discrete Instruments

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This paper: Instrumental Variables (IV) with Multiple Treatments

Setting:

- Finitely-supported treatment: $\mathcal{D}$ is finite, ordered or unordered
- Finitely-supported instrument: $\mathcal{Z}$ is finite, common in empirical work
- Y may be continuous: $\mathcal{Y}$ compact convex subset of $\mathbb{R}^n$, or finite
- Randomly assigned instruments, not just mean independent

Goal: Unified (partial) identification approach that allows flexible choice of target parameter and treatment selection (or choice) model

Scope: Models that impose assumptions on selection, but not outcome

Model

Observables (Y, D, Z) , unobservables $(\mathbf{V}, \varepsilon_Y)$, functions g_D and g_Y :

Treatment Selection Equation: $D = g_D(Z, \mathbf{V})$,

Outcome Equation: $Y = g_Y(D, \mathbf{V}, \varepsilon_Y)$,

Independence Condition: $Z, \mathbf{V}, \varepsilon_Y$ are mutually independent.

So far, **formally equivalent** to usual potential outcomes IV model, define potential outcomes and treatments:

$$Y_d := g_Y(d, \mathbf{V}, \varepsilon_Y) \text{ ,}$$

$$D_z := g_D(z, \mathbf{V}) \text{ .}$$

This paper:

Models that impose assumptions on selection, but not outcome

- **Allow:** assumptions on treatment selection equation,
i.e. restrictions on g_D and/or on $\mathbf{V}$
- **Avoid:** assumptions on outcome equation

Selection Models and Response-Types

Define an individual's **response-type**, denoted $\mathbf{T}$, as the random vector

$$\mathbf{T}(\mathbf{V}) = \mathbf{T} := (D_z : z \in \mathcal{Z}) = (g_D(z, \mathbf{V}) : z \in \mathcal{Z})$$

- Conditional on $\mathbf{T}$, D is randomly assigned (determined by $\mathcal{Z}$)
- Selection models restrict the set of admissible distributions for $\mathbf{T}$

Heckman and Pinto (2018): **discrete IV identification problem is finite mixture problem** involving response-type conditional distributions

- **This paper:** **attack mixture problem directly**, develop new results on (partial) identification of components in such mixture models

Overview of Results

For **any** selection model, paper provides **tractable** characterizations of

1. their empirical content and **(sharp) testable implications**,
2. the identified set for a large class of target parameters, including mean counterfactuals such as **counterfactual choice probabilities**, mean outcomes, and **mean treatment effects**,
3. the identified set for (joint) **potential outcome distributions**.

→ Results are **sharp under random assignment** of Z

The proposed approach can be used to derive:

- **Analytic bounds** on target parameters → not “black box”
- Inclusion tests for **inference on target parameters**
 - can be inverted to construct confidence regions
- **Specification tests** for treatment selection models

For “large” problems where analytic methods may be impractical, propose computationally feasible algorithm.

Example: Moving to Opportunity (MTO) Experiment

Let D denote neighbourhood choice. Here, individuals choose from three different types of neighbourhoods: “high” poverty (H), “medium” poverty (M), and “low” poverty (L).

Let $Z = (Z_M, Z_L)$ be the randomly assigned instrument. Individuals living in high poverty neighbourhoods were randomly offered rent vouchers:

$(Z_M, Z_L) = (0, 0)$: No vouchers

$(Z_M, Z_L) = (0, 1)$: Vouchers for L neighbourhoods

$(Z_M, Z_L) = (1, 1)$: Vouchers for M and L neighbourhoods

→ Therefore, $D \in \{H, M, L\}$ and $Z \in \{(0, 0), (0, 1), (1, 1)\}$.

→ Response-type: $T = (D_{(0,0)}, D_{(0,1)}, D_{(1,1)})$.

Example: Moving to Opportunity (MTO) Experiment

Suppose we impose “Unordered Partial Monotonicity” (Mountjoy, 2022):

- Z_M incentivizes $D = M$ and Z_L incentivizes $D = L$
- Changes in Z don't effect choices among irrelevant alternatives (e.g., $Z : (0, 0) \rightarrow (0, 1)$ cannot cause $D : H \rightarrow M$)

Shifting $Z : (1, 1) \rightarrow (0, 1)$ causes two types of moves:

- Individuals with $T \in \{(H, L, M), (M, L, M), (L, L, M)\}$: $M \rightarrow L$
- Individuals with $T = (H, H, M)$: $M \rightarrow H$

The following weighted average can be (point) identified

$$\omega_{M \rightarrow L} E \left[Y_L - Y_M \mid D_{(0,1)} = L, D_{(1,1)} = M \right] \\ + \omega_{M \rightarrow H} E \left[Y_H - Y_M \mid D_{(0,1)} = H, D_{(1,1)} = M \right] ,$$

but the two component effects are only partially identified.

Other Examples of Potential Applications

- Multi-dimensional instrument(s) or treatment(s)
 - **Multi-dimensional treatment:** disentangling different dimensions
 - Mediation: want to separate direct, indirect, and total effects
 - More generally: settings with complex incentive schemes, or complicated relationship between Z and D
- Ordered Treatments: e.g., Impact of Incarceration, Schooling etc.
- Nonparametric Discrete Choice Models
 - **MTO, Head Start**, College Choice...
- Other settings with multi-dimensional heterogeneity
 - Survey/RCT Non-Response Bias (e.g., Dutz et al., 2022)
- Exclusion Restriction Violations and/or Sample Selection Problems
 - See, e.g., Kroft, Mourifié, and Vayalinkal (2024)
- Sensitivity analysis for point-identified models
 - In the spirit of Noack (2021)

Parameters of Interest

Today: For simplicity:

- assume **scalar continuous** Y , supported on an interval $\mathcal{Y} \subseteq \mathbb{R}$
- focus on models that simply **eliminate** some response-types
 - i.e. models that restrict

$$\mathcal{T} := \text{supp}(\mathbf{T}) = \{\tau_1, \dots, \tau_{N_T}\}$$

(basic example: “**monotonicity**” = “**no defiers**”)

- focus on (weighted averages of) parameters of the form

$$E[Y_d - Y_{d'} \mid \mathbf{T} = \boldsymbol{\tau}],$$

→ examples include **ATE**, **ATT**, **ATUT**, (generalized) **LATE**, **PRTE** etc.

Related IV Literature

Point Identification: Angrist and Imbens (1995)... Heckman and Vytlacil (1999, 2001, 2007a,b)... Kirkebøen et al. (2016); [Heckman and Pinto \(2018\)](#); Lee and Salanié (2018); Mountjoy (2022)...

Partial Identification: Manski (1989, 1990); Balke and Pearl (1997)... Beresteanu et al. (2012)... Mogstad et al. (2018); Torgovitsky (2019); Kitagawa (2021); [Kamat et al. \(2023\)](#); Marx (2024)...

- **This paper:** sharp under full IV independence for any selection model; allows multivalued treatments and continuous outcomes; tractable, but not “black box”
- **This paper cannot:** incorporate general assumptions on outcomes or continuous instruments

Specification Testing : Kitagawa (2015); Mourifié and Wan (2017); Kédagni and Mourifié (2020); Sun (2023)...

- **This paper:** sharp test for general selection models with discrete IV

IV Mixture Model: Basic Idea

For any $d \in \mathcal{D}$ and each $z \in \mathcal{Z}$,

We observe Y for those assigned $Z = z$ and took treatment d

We want to learn about Y_d for those of type $T = \tau$, for some $\tau \in \mathcal{T}$

Key: Individuals who take treatment $D = d$ when $Z = z$ consists of the mixture of individuals of types $T = \tau$ such that $\tau(z) = d$.

→ Observed outcome distributions are mixture distributions:

$$\begin{aligned} \sum_{\tau \in \mathcal{T}} \underbrace{\mathbb{1}\{\tau(z) = d\}}_{\text{known}} \underbrace{P(T = \tau) P(Y_d \leq y \mid T = \tau)}_{\text{unobserved}} \\ = \underbrace{P(D = d \mid Z = z) P(Y \leq y \mid D = d, Z = z)}_{\text{observed}}, \end{aligned}$$

→ Allowing Z to vary, get linear system with known coefficients

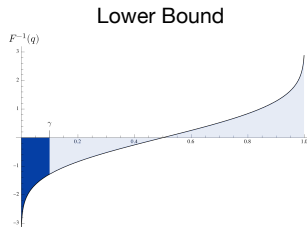
“Trimming” Bounds of Horowitz and Manski (1995)

Suppose all we observe is the following mixture distribution, with CDF F ,

$$F(y) = \gamma F_1(y) + (1 - \gamma) F_2(y) ,$$

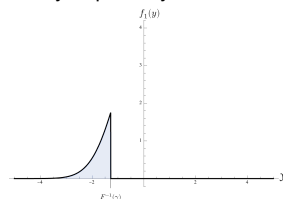
where $\gamma \in (0, 1)$ is known, but F_1 and F_2 are unknown CDFs. Let $Y_1 \sim F_1$.

If $\gamma = 0.1$, sharp lower bound for $E[Y_1]$ is constructed as follows:



(a) Lower bound is area of shaded region

Density Implied by Lower Bound



(b) Density of F_1

Figure 1: Sharp lower bound for $E[Y_1]$, with $\gamma = 0.1$

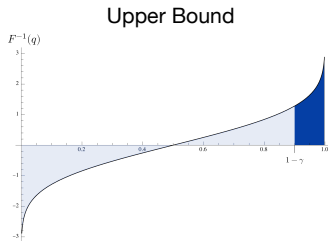
“Trimming” Bounds of Horowitz and Manski (1995)

Suppose all we observe is the following mixture distribution, with CDF F ,

$$F(y) = \gamma F_1(y) + (1 - \gamma) F_2(y),$$

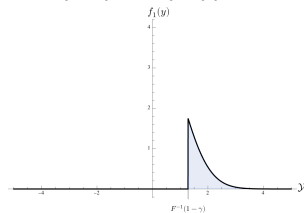
where $\gamma \in (0, 1)$ is known, but F_1 and F_2 are unknown CDFs. Let $Y_1 \sim F_1$.

If $\gamma = 0.1$, sharp **upper** bound for $E[Y_1]$ is constructed as follows:



(a) Upper bound is area of shaded region

Density Implied by Upper Bound



(b) Density of F_1

Figure 1: Sharp upper bound for $E[Y_1]$, with $\gamma = 0.1$

“Trimming” Bounds of Horowitz and Manski (1995)

If instead we have $\gamma = 0.9$, then lower bound is

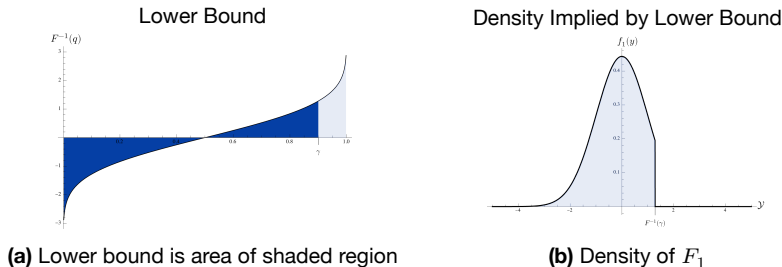


Figure 2: Sharp lower bound for $E[Y_1]$, with $\gamma = 0.9$

“Trimming” Bounds of Horowitz and Manski (1995)

and upper bound is

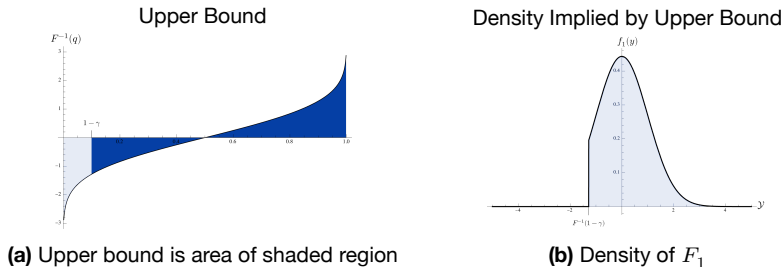


Figure 2: Sharp upper bound for $E[Y_1]$, with $\gamma = 0.9$

Horowitz and Manski (1995) Bounds: Takeaway

The observed mixture distribution, written in terms of densities, is

$$f(y) = \gamma f_1(y) + (1 - \gamma) f_2(y),$$

where f_1 is the density of F_1 , and f_2 is the density of F_2 .

This implies two restrictions on the function $\gamma f_1(\cdot)$:

→ point-wise restriction: $0 \leq \gamma f_1(y) \leq f(y)$, for all y

→ mass restriction: $\int_{-\infty}^{\infty} f_1(y) d\mu(y) = 1 \implies \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \gamma f_1(y) d\mu(y) = \gamma$

Note that $E[Y_1] := \frac{1}{\gamma} \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} y \gamma f_1(y) d\mu(y)$

→ optimizing the right hand side over all functions $\gamma f_1(\cdot)$ that satisfy the two conditions above results in the Horowitz-Manski bounds

Example 1: Head Start Impact Study

Let D denote preschool choice. Families choose between no preschool (n), competing preschools (c), and Head Start (h) for their child.

The Head Start Impact Study randomized applicants into two groups:

$Z = 0$: Not offered admission to Head Start

$Z = 1$: Offered admission to Head Start.

→ Therefore, $D \in \{n, c, h\}$ and $Z \in \{0, 1\}$.

→ Response-type: $T = (D_0, D_1)$.

Example 1 (Head Start): Partial Identification

Assume that the following assumption holds for everyone

- either $D_1 = D_0$ or $\mathbb{1}\{D_1 = h\} > \mathbb{1}\{D_0 = h\}$

Shifting $Z : 0 \rightarrow 1$ causes two types of enrolment changes:

- Individuals with $T = (n, h)$: $n \rightarrow h$
- Individuals with $T = (c, h)$: $c \rightarrow h$

The following weighted average can be (point) identified

$$\omega_{n \rightarrow h} E[Y_h - Y_n \mid D_0 = n, D_1 = h] \\ + \omega_{c \rightarrow h} E[Y_h - Y_c \mid D_0 = c, D_1 = h] ,$$

but the two component effects are only partially identified.

Example 1 (Head Start): “ h ”-response-type

Consider the effect $E[Y_h - Y_c \mid \mathbf{T} = (ch)]$

→ $P[\mathbf{T} = (ch)]$ and $E[Y_c \mid \mathbf{T} = (ch)]$ are point-identified

→ Therefore, it suffices to find the bounds for

$$\begin{aligned} P[\mathbf{T} = (ch)] E[Y_h \mid \mathbf{T} = (ch)] &= E[Y_h \mathbb{1}\{\mathbf{T} = (ch)\}] \\ &= \int_{\mathcal{Y}} P[\mathbf{T} = (ch)] f_{Y_h \mid \mathbf{T} = (ch)}(y) d\mu(y) \end{aligned}$$

There are two types such that $D_0 \neq h$ and $D_1 = h$:

$$\{(ch), (nh)\}$$

Example 1 (Head Start): Pointwise Restriction

Define

$$\xi_{Y_h|T=(ch)}(y) := P[T = (ch)] f_{Y_h|T=(ch)}(y),$$

and $\xi_{Y_h|T=(nh)}(y) := P[T = (nh)] f_{Y_h|T=(nh)}(y).$

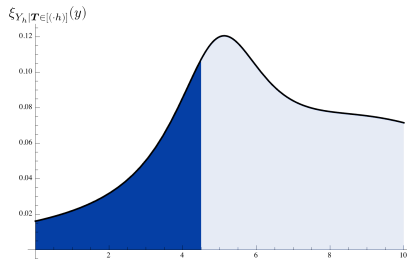
Now, note that

$$\begin{aligned} & P(D = h|Z = 1) f_{Y|D=h,Z=1}(y) - P(D = h|Z = 0) f_{Y|D=h,Z=0}(y) \\ &= \xi_{Y_h|T=(ch)}(y) + \xi_{Y_h|T=(nh)}(y) \end{aligned}$$

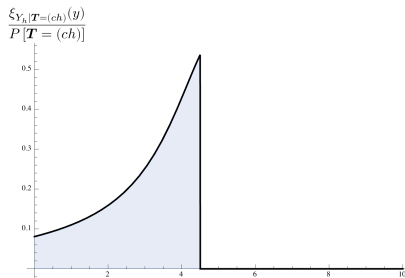
Defining $\xi_{Y_h|T \in [(\cdot h)]} := \xi_{Y_h|T=(ch)}(y) + \xi_{Y_h|T=(nh)}(y)$, we can “trim” the identified function $\xi_{Y_h|T \in [(\cdot h)]}$ to get sharp bounds on $E[Y_h|T = (ch)]$.

Example 1 (Head Start): Sharp Lower Bound

Suppose $P[T = (ch)] = 0.2$.



(a) Dark blue region has area 0.2.



(b) Density $\frac{\xi_{Y_h|T=(ch)}}{P[T=(ch)]} = f_{Y_h|T=(ch)}$ implied by sharp lower bound

Figure 3: (Simulated) Construction of sharp lower bound for $E[Y_h|T = (ch)]$

Example 2 (MTO): “M”-response-type

Recall: $D \in \{H, M, L\}$ and $Z = (Z_M, Z_L) \in \{(0, 0), (0, 1), (1, 1)\}$.

Response-type: $\mathbf{T} = (D_{(0,0)} D_{(0,1)} D_{(1,1)})$.

Consider the effect $E[Y_H - Y_M \mid \mathbf{T} = (HHM)]$

→ $P[\mathbf{T} = (HHM)]$ and $E[Y_H \mid \mathbf{T} = (HHM)]$ are point-identified

→ Therefore, it suffices to find the bounds for

$$\begin{aligned} P[\mathbf{T} = (HHM)] E[Y_M \mid \mathbf{T} = (HHM)] &= \int_{\mathcal{Y}} P[\mathbf{T} = (HHM)] f_{Y_M \mid \mathbf{T} = (HHM)}(y) d\mu(y) \\ &=: \int_{\mathcal{Y}} \xi_{Y_M \mid \mathbf{T} = (HHM)}(y) d\mu(y) \end{aligned}$$

There are three types such that $D_{(0,0)} \neq M$, $D_{(0,1)} \neq M$ and $D_{(1,1)} = M$:

$$\{(HHM), (HLM), (LLM)\}$$

Example 2 (MTO): Pointwise Restrictions

In this case, the aggregate density

$$\xi_{Y_M|T \in [(\cdot M)]}(y) := \xi_{Y_M|T=(HHM)}(y) + \xi_{Y_M|T=(HLM)}(y) + \xi_{Y_M|T=(LLM)}(y)$$

is not point-identified, but it can be bounded.

Here,

$$\begin{aligned} & P[D = M|Z = (1, 1)] f_{Y|D=M, Z=(1,1)}(y) \\ &= \xi_{Y_M|T \in [(\cdot M)]}(y) + \xi_{Y_M|T=(MMM)}(y) + \xi_{Y_M|T=(MLM)}(y) . \end{aligned}$$

First, we have that

$$\begin{aligned} & P[D = M|Z = (1, 1)] f_{Y|D=M, Z=(1,1)} - P[D = M|Z = (0, 1)] f_{Y|D=M, Z=(0,1)} \\ &= \xi_{Y_M|T \in [(\cdot M)]} + \xi_{Y_M|T=(MLM)} \\ &\geq \xi_{Y_M|T \in [(\cdot M)]} \end{aligned}$$

Define $\bar{f}^*(y)$ to be this bound.

Example 2 (MTO): Pointwise Restrictions

In this case, the aggregate density

$$\xi_{Y_M|T \in [(\cdot M)]}(y) := \xi_{Y_M|T=(HHM)}(y) + \xi_{Y_M|T=(HLM)}(y) + \xi_{Y_M|T=(LLM)}(y)$$

is not point-identified, but it can be bounded.

Here,

$$\begin{aligned} & P[D = M|Z = (1, 1)] f_{Y|D=M, Z=(1,1)}(y) \\ &= \xi_{Y_M|T \in [(\cdot M)]}(y) + \xi_{Y_M|T=(MMM)}(y) + \xi_{Y_M|T=(MLM)}(y) . \end{aligned}$$

Next, we have that

$$\begin{aligned} & P[D = M|Z = (1, 1)] f_{Y|D=M, Z=(1,1)} - P[D = M|Z = (0, 0)] f_{Y|D=M, Z=(0,0)} \\ &= \xi_{Y_M|T \in [(\cdot M)]} - \xi_{Y_M|T=(MLL)} \\ &\leq \xi_{Y_M|T \in [(\cdot M)]} \end{aligned}$$

Define $\underline{f}^*(y)$ to be the pointwise maximum of 0 and this bound.

Example 2 (MTO): Simple Bounds

So, we have the pointwise bounds $\underline{f}^*(y) \leq \mathbb{E}_{Y_M | T \in [(\cdot, M)]}(y) \leq \overline{f}^*(y)$:

- valid bound on $P[T = (HHM)] E[Y_M | T = (HHM)]$ can be obtained by trimming $\overline{f}^*(y)$
- however, this bound is not generally sharp

This is because the resulting bound may imply a value of

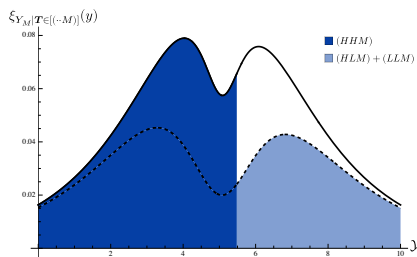
$$P[T \in [(\cdot, M)]] := P[T = (HHM)] + P[T = (HLM)] + P[T = (LLM)]$$

that may not be feasible.

Example 2 (MTO): Non-Sharpness of Simple Bounds

Suppose the sharp upper bound on $P[T \in [(\cdot \cdot M)]]$ is 0.36, and $P[T = (HHM)] = 0.28$.

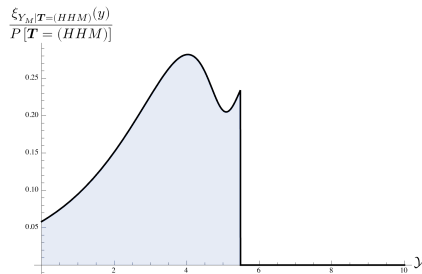
Construction of Simple Lower Bound



dark blue area = 0.28

dark blue area + light blue area = 0.423

Density $f_{Y_M|T=(HHM)}$ Implied by Simple Lower Bound



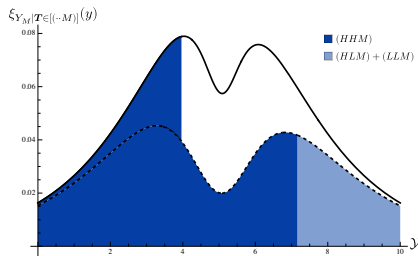
This density implies the simple lower bound of 3.289

Figure 4: (Simulated) Construction of lower bounds for $E[Y_M|T = (HHM)]$

Example 2 (MTO): Non-Sharpness of Simple Bounds

Suppose the sharp upper bound on $P[T \in [(\cdot \cdot M)]]$ is 0.36, and $P[T = (HHM)] = 0.28$.

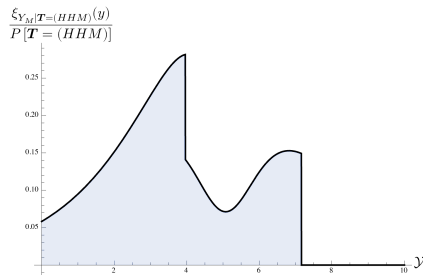
Construction of Sharp Lower Bound



dark blue area = 0.28

dark blue area + light blue area = 0.36

Density $f_{Y_M|T=(HHM)}$ Implied by Sharp Lower Bound



This density implies the sharp lower bound of 3.665

Figure 4: (Simulated) Construction of lower bounds for $E[Y_M|T = (HHM)]$

Example 3: Multi-dimensional Treatment

Consider a setting with a **primary treatment**, $P \in \{0, 1\}$, and **supplementary treatment**, $S \in \{0, 1\}$, and define $D = (P, S)$.

Some individuals are randomly offered incentives to participate in treatment. Let $Z = (Z_P, Z_S)$ where

- $Z_P \in \{0, 1\}$ represents an **incentive to participate in P**
- $Z_S \in \{0, 1\}$ represents an **additional incentive to participate in S**

Suppose individuals are

- only offered supplementary incentive if offered primary incentive
- only allowed supplementary treatment if they take primary treatment

→ Therefore, $D \in \{(0, 0), (1, 0), (1, 1)\}$ and $Z \in \{(0, 0), (1, 0), (1, 1)\}$.

→ Response-type: $T = (D_{(0,0)}, D_{(1,0)}, D_{(1,1)})$.

Multi-dimensional Treatment Example

Assume that the following holds for all individuals:

1. $Z_P : 0 \rightarrow 1$ (weakly) increases $\mathbb{1}\{D \in \{(1, 0), (1, 1)\}\}$ and $\mathbb{1}\{S = 1\}$,
2. $Z_S : 0 \rightarrow 1$ (weakly) increases $\mathbb{1}\{D = (1, 1)\}$ and $\mathbb{1}\{P = 1\}$.

Many potential parameters of interest...

For example, consider the decomposition

$$\begin{aligned} & \underbrace{E \left[Y_{(1,1)} - Y_{(0,0)} \mid \mathbf{T} = ((0, 0), (1, 0), (1, 1)) \right]}_{\text{Total Effect}} \\ &= \underbrace{E \left[Y_{(1,1)} - Y_{(1,0)} \mid \mathbf{T} = ((0, 0), (1, 0), (1, 1)) \right]}_{\text{Supplementary Effect}} \\ &+ \underbrace{E \left[Y_{(1,0)} - Y_{(0,0)} \mid \mathbf{T} = ((0, 0), (1, 0), (1, 1)) \right]}_{\text{Primary Effect}} \end{aligned}$$

→ **All components are only partially identified!**

Multi-dim. Treatment example: Singleton “(1, 0)”-response-type

Let's focus on the mean outcome $E[Y_{(1,0)} \mid \mathbf{T} = (00, 10, 11)]$.

→ there are no other response-types such that

$$D_{(0,0)} \neq (1, 0), D_{(1,1)} \neq (1, 0) \text{ and } D_{(1,0)} = (1, 0)$$

→ $\xi_{Y_{(1,0)}|\mathbf{T}=(00,10,11)}$ is not point-identified, but can be bounded

Define $\mathbf{pf}_{d|Z=z}(y) := P(D = d | Z = z) f_{Y|D=d, Z=z}(y)$.

Proceeding as before, we have the bounds

$$\begin{aligned} \underline{f}^*(y) &:= \max \left\{ 0, \mathbf{pf}_{(1,0)|Z=(1,0)}(y) - \mathbf{pf}_{(1,0)|Z=(1,1)}(y) - \mathbf{pf}_{(1,0)|Z=(0,0)}(y) \right\} \\ &\leq \xi_{Y_{(1,0)}|\mathbf{T}=(00,10,11)}(y) \leq \\ &\quad \mathbf{pf}_{(1,0)|Z=(1,0)}(y) - \mathbf{pf}_{(1,0)|Z=(1,1)}(y) =: \bar{f}^*(y) , \end{aligned}$$

Multi-dim. Treatment example: Trimming Failure

We have $\underline{f}^*(y) \leq \xi_{Y_{(1,0)}|T=(00,10,11)}(y) \leq \overline{f}^*(y)$

For simplicity, assume that $P[T = (00, 10, 11)]$ is identified, and define

$$\bar{p} := P[T = (00, 10, 11)] - \int_{\mathcal{Y}} \underline{f}^*(y) d\mu(y) .$$

Simple bounds can be constructed as follows:

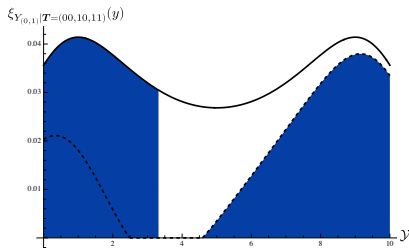
- (i) Trim $\overline{f}^* - \underline{f}^*$ up to mass $\bar{p}$
- (ii) Add this to the density implied by lower bound, $\underline{f}^*(y)$

→ The resulting bounds are valid, but **still not generally sharp**.

Multi-dim. Treatment example: Tighter Bounds due to Pointwise Dependence

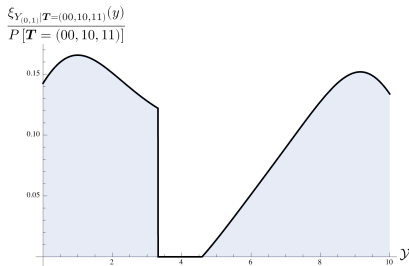
Suppose $P[T = (00, 10, 11)] = 0.25$.

Construction of Simple Lower Bound



dark blue area = 0.25

Density $f_{Y_{(1,0)}|T=(00,10,11)}$ Implied by
Simple Lower Bound



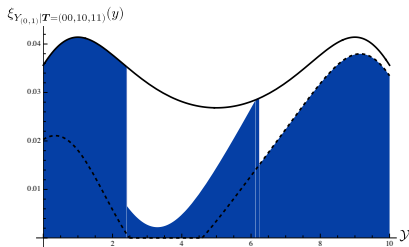
This density implies the simple lower bound
of 4.865

Figure 5: Construction of lower bounds for $E[Y_{(1,0)}|T = (00, 10, 11)]$

Multi-dim. Treatment example: Tighter Bounds due to Pointwise Dependence

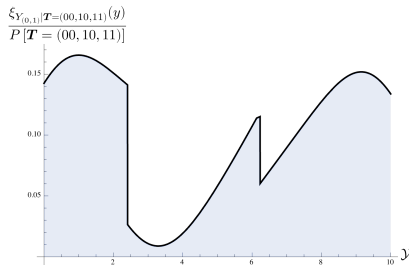
Suppose $P[T = (00, 10, 11)] = 0.25$.

Construction of Sharp Lower Bound



dark blue area = 0.25

Density $f_{Y_{(1,0)}|T=(00,10,11)}$ Implied by
Sharp Lower Bound



This density implies the sharp lower bound
of 5.106

Figure 5: Construction of lower bounds for $E[Y_{(1,0)}|T = (00, 10, 11)]$

IV Mixture Model: Notation

Enumerate instrument values as $\mathcal{Z} := \{1, \dots, N_Z\}$. For any random variables X_1, X_2 , let $f_{X_1|X_2}$ be the density of $X_1|X_2$.

For $d \in \mathcal{D}$ and $y \in \mathcal{Y}$, define $\mathbf{pf}_d$ as the **observed** vector of weighted densities

$$\mathbf{pf}_d(y) := \begin{bmatrix} P(D = d|Z = 1) f_{Y|D=d,Z=1}(y) \\ \vdots \\ P(D = d|Z = N_Z) f_{Y|D=d,Z=N_Z}(y) \end{bmatrix}$$

Define π as the **unobserved** vector of response-type probabilities,

$$\pi := \begin{bmatrix} P(T = \tau_1) \\ \vdots \\ P(T = \tau_{N_T}) \end{bmatrix}$$

and define ξ_d as the **unobserved** vector of weighted response-type densities

$$\xi_d(y) := \begin{bmatrix} P(T = \tau_1) f_{Y_d|T=\tau_1}(y) \\ \vdots \\ P(T = \tau_{N_T}) f_{Y_d|T=\tau_{N_T}}(y) \end{bmatrix}$$

IV Mixture Model: Notation

Finally, define the d -response-matrix as

$$\mathbf{R}_d := \begin{bmatrix} \mathbb{1}\{\tau_1(1) = d\} & \dots & \mathbb{1}\{\tau_{N_T}(1) = d\} \\ \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ \mathbb{1}\{\tau_0(N_Z) = d\} & \dots & \mathbb{1}\{\tau_{N_T}(N_Z) = d\} \end{bmatrix},$$

which is the **known** binary matrix that indicates **when each response-type takes treatment d** (as in Heckman and Pinto, 2018).

Basic Example ($Z \in \{0, 1\}$, $D \in \{0, 1\}$, no restrictions on selection) : In this case, the response types are always-takers (AT), compliers (C), defiers (D), never-takers (NT) , leading to

$$\mathbf{R}_0 = \begin{matrix} & \begin{matrix} \text{(AT)} & \text{(C)} & \text{(D)} & \text{(NT)} \end{matrix} \\ \begin{bmatrix} 0 & 1 & 0 & 1 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 & 1 \end{bmatrix} & \begin{matrix} (Z = 0) \\ (Z = 1) \end{matrix} \end{matrix} \quad \text{and} \quad \mathbf{R}_1 = \begin{matrix} & \begin{matrix} \text{(AT)} & \text{(C)} & \text{(D)} & \text{(NT)} \end{matrix} \\ \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 1 & 0 \\ 1 & 1 & 0 & 0 \end{bmatrix} & \begin{matrix} (Z = 0) \\ (Z = 1) \end{matrix} \end{matrix}$$

IV Mixture Model

Using this notation, we have the following system for $d \in \mathcal{D}$ and $y \in \mathcal{Y}$

$$\mathbf{R}_d \boldsymbol{\xi}_d(y) = \mathbf{p} \mathbf{f}_d(y) \quad \text{and} \quad \boldsymbol{\xi}_d(y) \geq 0 \quad (\star)$$

When $(\star)$ is underdetermined, $\boldsymbol{\xi}_d(y)$ is generally not point-identified.

Proposition 1 (due to Heckman and Pinto (2018))

For any $\mathbf{c} \in \mathbb{R}^{|\mathcal{T}|}$,

$\mathbf{c} \in \text{row-span}(\mathbf{R}_d) \implies \mathbf{c}^\top \boldsymbol{\xi}_d$ is point-identified ,

$\mathbf{c} \in \text{row-span} \left(\begin{bmatrix} \mathbf{R}_1 \\ \vdots \\ \mathbf{R}_{N_D} \end{bmatrix} \right) \implies \mathbf{c}^\top \boldsymbol{\pi}$ is point-identified .

→ Equivalent to Theorem T-2 in Heckman and Pinto (2018), where it is stated in terms of the Moore-Penrose generalized inverse of $\mathbf{R}_d$

Informal Outline of Approach

Step 0: Selection model determines set of possible response-types, $\mathcal{T}$

Step 1: For each $d \in \mathcal{D}$, $\xi_d(y)$ must be a solution to $(\star)$ which imposes

1a. restrictions on π , i.e. distribution of T

1b. restrictions on the conditional distribution of $Y_d|T$

Step 2: Get identified set for π by combining restrictions from Step 1 over treatments $d \in \mathcal{D}$

- Optional: incorporate additional assumptions on treatment selection
- Reject selection model iff this set is empty (sharp specification test)

Step 3: Define parameter of interest (e.g., ATE)

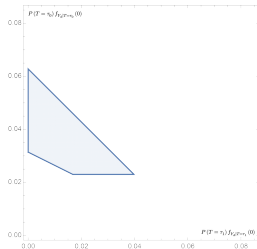
- Possible values for this parameter are those consistent with restrictions from Steps 1 and 2

$\xi_d(y)$ must be a solution to $(\star)$

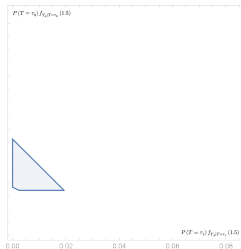
Fix $d \in \mathcal{D}$. For $y \in \mathcal{Y}$, the set of solutions to $(\star)$ define a convex polytope

$$\mathcal{B}_d(\mathbf{pf}_d(y)) := \left\{ \mathbf{x} \in \mathbb{R}_{\geq 0}^{|\mathcal{T}|} \mid \mathbf{R}_d \mathbf{x} = \mathbf{pf}_d(y) \right\}.$$

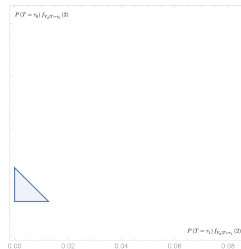
→ By $(\star)$, we require that $\xi_d(y) \in \mathcal{B}_d(\mathbf{pf}_d(y))$ for each $y \in \mathcal{Y}$.



(a) $\tilde{\mathcal{B}}_d(\mathbf{pf}_d(0))$



(b) $\tilde{\mathcal{B}}_d(\mathbf{pf}_d(1.5))$



(c) $\tilde{\mathcal{B}}_d(\mathbf{pf}_d(2))$

Figure 6: Hypothetical $\tilde{\mathcal{B}}_d(\mathbf{pf}_d(\cdot))$ in a case with 2 “degrees of freedom”

$\xi_d(y)$ must be a solution to $(\star)$

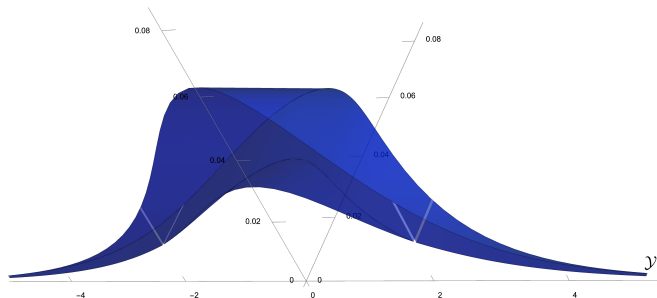


Figure 7: Hypothetical graph of the correspondence $y \mapsto \tilde{\mathcal{B}}_d(\mathbf{pf}_d(y))$

$\xi_d(y)$ must be a solution to $(\star)$

→ If $\mathbf{x}$ is a vector-valued function such that $\mathbf{x}(y) \in \mathcal{B}_d(\mathbf{p}\mathbf{f}_d(y))$ for all $y \in \mathcal{Y}$, then $\mathbf{x}$ is a “candidate” for $\xi_d(y)$.

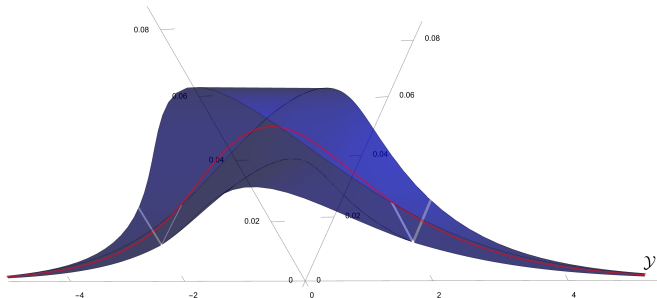
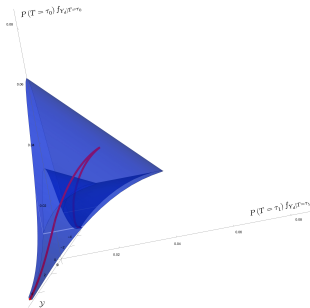


Figure 7: Hypothetical graph of the correspondence $y \mapsto \tilde{\mathcal{B}}_d(\mathbf{p}\mathbf{f}_d(y))$

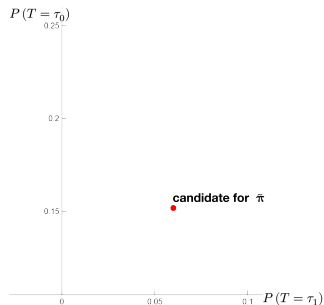
Candidates for π

If $\mathbf{x}$ is a candidate for $\xi_d(y)$, then $\int_{\mathcal{Y}} \mathbf{x}(y) \, d\mu(y)$ is a candidate for π , the vector of response-type probabilities. Precisely,

$$\mathbf{x} = \xi_d \implies \int_{\mathcal{Y}} \mathbf{x}(y) \, d\mu(y) = \pi$$



(a) $\mathbf{x}(y) \in \mathcal{B}_d(\mathbf{p}\mathbf{f}_d(y)) \, \forall y \in \mathcal{Y}$



(b) $\int_{\mathcal{Y}} \mathbf{x}(y) \, d\mu(y)$

Candidates for π

If $\mathbf{x}$ is a candidate for $\xi_d(y)$, then $\int_{\mathcal{Y}} \mathbf{x}(y) d\mu(y)$ is a candidate for π , the vector of response-type probabilities. Precisely,

$$\mathbf{x} = \xi_d \implies \int_{\mathcal{Y}} \mathbf{x}(y) d\mu(y) = \pi$$

Define $\Pi_{\mathcal{T}|d}$ as the set of such candidates for π :

$$\begin{aligned} \Pi_{\mathcal{T}|d} &:= \left\{ \int_{\mathcal{Y}} \mathbf{x}(y) d\mu(y) \left| \begin{array}{l} \text{measurable } \mathbf{x} : \mathcal{Y} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}_{\geq 0}^{|\mathbf{T}|} \\ \mathbf{R}_d \mathbf{x}(y) = \mathbf{p} \mathbf{f}_d(y), \forall y \in \mathcal{Y} \end{array} \right. \right\} \\ &= \left\{ \int_{\mathcal{Y}} \mathbf{x}(y) d\mu(y) \left| \begin{array}{l} \text{measurable } \mathbf{x} : \mathcal{Y} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^{|\mathbf{T}|} \\ \mathbf{x}(y) \in \mathcal{B}_d(\mathbf{p} \mathbf{f}_d(y)), \forall y \in \mathcal{Y} \end{array} \right. \right\}. \end{aligned}$$

$\rightarrow \Pi_{\mathcal{T}|d}$ is a convex polytope, and its boundary can be obtained by integrating along the boundary of $\mathcal{B}_d(\mathbf{p} \mathbf{f}_d(y))$

Candidates for π

Define $\Pi_{\mathcal{T}|d}$ as the set of such candidates for π :

$$\Pi_{\mathcal{T}|d} := \left\{ \int_{\mathcal{Y}} \mathbf{x}(y) \, d\mu(y) \mid \begin{array}{l} \text{measurable } \mathbf{x} : \mathcal{Y} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^{|\mathbf{T}|} \\ \mathbf{x}(y) \in \mathcal{B}_d(\mathbf{pf}_d(y)), \forall y \in \mathcal{Y} \end{array} \right\}.$$

Comments

- We must have $\pi \in \Pi_{\mathcal{T}|d}$ for every $d \in \mathcal{D}$.
- $\Pi_{\mathcal{T}|d} = \emptyset$ iff $\mathcal{B}_d(\mathbf{pf}_d(y)) = \emptyset$ for some $y \in \mathcal{Y}$.
- $\Pi_{\mathcal{T}|d}$ is the *Minkowski integral* of the map $y \mapsto \mathcal{B}_d(\mathbf{pf}_d(y))$
 - Continuous analogue to Minkowski sum (Billera and Sturmfels, 1992)
 - Close connection to *Aumann expectation* from theory of random sets (Artstein and Vitale, 1975): both are adaptations of Aumann (1965)'s integral for set-valued measures

Candidates for π : Support Function

For any non-empty closed convex set $C \subseteq \mathbb{R}^n$, let its **support function** be defined pointwise, for $c \in \mathbb{R}^n$, as

$$\nu(c; C) := \sup_{x \in C} c^\top x .$$

→ Every non-empty closed convex set is uniquely determined by its support function.

Lemma 1

Suppose $\mathcal{T} \subseteq \mathcal{D}^{\mathcal{Z}}$ is such that $\mathcal{B}_d(\mathbf{p}\mathbf{f}_d(y)) \neq \emptyset$ for all $y \in \mathcal{Y}$. Then $\Pi_{\mathcal{T}|d}$ is a non-empty convex set such that, for all $c \in \mathbb{R}^{|\mathcal{T}|}$

$$\nu(c; \Pi_{\mathcal{T}|d}) = \int_{\mathcal{Y}} \nu(c; \mathcal{B}_d(\mathbf{p}\mathbf{f}_d(y))) \, d\mu(y) .$$

Further, $\Pi_{\mathcal{T}|d}$ is a convex polytope.

Identified Set for Response-Type Probabilities

Let $\mathcal{Q}$ be the set of joint distributions $((Y_d : d \in \mathcal{D}), (D_z : z \in \mathcal{Z}), Z)$ that are consistent with the model and the observed data. For $\mathcal{T} \subseteq \mathcal{D}^{\mathcal{Z}}$, define

$$\mathcal{Q}_{\mathcal{T}} := \left\{ Q \in \mathcal{Q} \mid \text{supp}_Q(\mathbf{T}) = \mathcal{T} \right\},$$

and define the identified set for π , under the assumption $\text{supp}(\mathbf{T}) = \mathcal{T}$,

$$\Pi_{\mathcal{T}} := \left\{ \left(Q(\mathbf{T} = \tau) : \tau \in \mathcal{T} \right) \mid Q \in \mathcal{Q}_{\mathcal{T}} \right\}.$$

Theorem 1 (Identified Set for Response-Type Probabilities)

For any $\mathcal{T} \subseteq \mathcal{D}^{\mathcal{Z}}$, $\Pi_{\mathcal{T}}$ is a compact convex polytope and

$$\Pi_{\mathcal{T}} = \bigcap_{d \in \mathcal{D}} \Pi_{\mathcal{T}|d}.$$

Moreover, $\mathcal{Q}_{\mathcal{T}} \neq \emptyset$ if and only if $\bigcap_{d \in \mathcal{D}} \Pi_{\mathcal{T}|d} \neq \emptyset$.

Some Implications of Theorem 1

Denote by $\left\{ \mathcal{Y} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}_{\geq 0}^{|\mathcal{T}|} \right\}$ the set of measurable functions $\mathbf{x} : \mathcal{Y} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}_{\geq 0}^{|\mathcal{T}|}$.

Corollary 1 (Identified Set for Marginal Outcome Distributions)

Fix $\mathcal{T} \subseteq \mathcal{D}^{\mathcal{Z}}$ and suppose $\text{supp}(\mathbf{T}) = \mathcal{T}$. Then, for any $d \in \mathcal{D}$, the identified set for ξ_d is

$$\Xi_{\mathcal{T}}(d) := \left\{ \mathbf{x} \in \left\{ \mathcal{Y} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}_{\geq 0}^{|\mathcal{T}|} \right\} \left| \begin{array}{l} \mathbf{R}_d \mathbf{x}(y) = \mathbf{p} \mathbf{f}_d(y), \forall y \in \mathcal{Y}; \\ \int_{\mathcal{Y}} \mathbf{x}(y) d\mu(y) \in \Pi_{\mathcal{T}} \end{array} \right. \right\}.$$

Further, the joint identification region for $(\xi_d : d \in \mathcal{D})$ is

$$\left\{ (\mathbf{x}_d : d \in \mathcal{D}) \left| \begin{array}{l} \forall d \in \mathcal{D}, \mathbf{x}_d \in \Xi_{\mathcal{T}}(d); \\ \exists \mathbf{p} \in \Pi_{\mathcal{T}} \text{ s.t. } \forall d \in \mathcal{D}, \int_{\mathcal{Y}} \mathbf{x}_d(y) d\mu(y) = \mathbf{p} \end{array} \right. \right\}$$

Comments

- Jointly tests $\text{supp}(\mathbf{T}) = \mathcal{T}$ and random assignment of Z
 - Assume potential outcomes exist, set $\mathcal{T} = \mathcal{D}^{|\mathcal{Z}|}$ in Theorem 1
 $\Rightarrow$ sharp test for random assignment of Z
- Theorem 1 requires (i) $\Pi_{\mathcal{T}|d} \neq \emptyset$ for each $d \in \mathcal{D}$, and (ii) $\bigcap_{d \in \mathcal{D}} \Pi_{\mathcal{T}|d} \neq \emptyset$
- $\Pi_{\mathcal{T}|d} \neq \emptyset$ iff $\text{pf}_d(y) \in \text{cone}(\mathbf{R}_d)$ for all $y \in \mathcal{Y}$
 - $\text{cone}(\mathbf{R}_d)$ is the polyhedral cone generated by positive linear combinations of the columns of $\mathbf{R}_d$
 - (i) is automatically satisfied in some cases; e.g., $\mathcal{T} = \mathcal{D}^{|\mathcal{Z}|}$
 - Possible to represent a joint test for (i) and (ii) as a test of conditional moment inequalities

Remaining content of the paper

1. **Identification** Remaining identification results, including under some assumptions on outcomes
2. **Analytic bounds**: Automated derivation of analytic expressions for “point-wise” bounds
3. **Inference**: Support function based test statistic for inclusion tests
4. **Computation**: Primal-dual method for computing support function
 - feasible for large problems, exact solution in finitely many steps
 - also useful for fast approximation with deterministic error bounds
5. **Theory**: Formalization of high-level claims made in the presentation

Conclusion

Summary

Framework for partial identification in IV treatment selection models

- multivalued treatments, discrete instruments
- sharp under random assignment of instrument
- tractable, not “black box”: analytic bounds
- sharp specification tests

Current and Future Work

- Formalizing inference and estimation
- Simulations and empirical applications
- Developing a Stata/R/Python package
- Additional guidance on when bounds are likely to be informative

Thank you!

Basic Example ($Z \in \{0, 1\}$, $D \in \{0, 1\}$, no selection restrictions)

For $d = 1$, $(\star)$ implies

$$\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 1 & 0 \\ 1 & 1 & 0 & 0 \end{bmatrix} \boldsymbol{\xi}_1(y) = \mathbf{p}\mathbf{f}_1(y)$$
$$\Rightarrow \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 1 \end{bmatrix} P(\mathbf{T} = AT) f_{Y_1|\mathbf{T}=AT}(y) \leq \begin{bmatrix} P(D=1|Z=0) f_{Y|D=1,Z=0}(y) \\ P(D=1|Z=1) f_{Y|D=1,Z=1}(y) \end{bmatrix}$$

The support function for the 1-dimensional polytope (i.e. interval) defined by the non-negative solutions to the above system is simply the map

$$c \mapsto \begin{cases} c \left(\min_{z \in \{0,1\}} \left\{ P(D=1|Z=z) f_{Y|D=1,Z=z}(y) \right\} \right) & \text{if } c \geq 0 \\ 0 & \text{if } c < 0 \end{cases}$$

Basic Example ($Z \in \{0, 1\}$, $D \in \{0, 1\}$, no selection restrictions)

$\Pi_{\mathcal{T}|1}$ consists of all $\pi \geq 0$ such that

$$\pi_{(AT)} \leq \int_{\mathcal{Y}} \min_{z \in \{0,1\}} \left\{ P(D=1|Z=z) f_{Y|D=1,Z=z}(y) \right\} d\mu(y) ,$$

$$\pi_{(AT)} + \pi_{(D)} = P(D=1|Z=0) = \int_{\mathcal{Y}} P(D=1|Z=0) f_{Y|D=1,Z=0}(y) d\mu(y) ,$$

$$\pi_{(AT)} + \pi_{(C)} = P(D=1|Z=1) = \int_{\mathcal{Y}} P(D=1|Z=1) f_{Y|D=1,Z=1}(y) d\mu(y) .$$

Similarly, $\Pi_{\mathcal{T}|0}$ consists of all $\pi \geq 0$ such that

$$\pi_{(NT)} \leq \int_{\mathcal{Y}} \min_{z \in \{0,1\}} \left\{ P(D=0|Z=z) f_{Y|D=0,Z=z}(y) \right\} d\mu(y) ,$$

$$\pi_{(C)} + \pi_{(NT)} = P(D=0|Z=0) ,$$

$$\pi_{(D)} + \pi_{(NT)} = P(D=0|Z=1) .$$

$\Pi_{\mathcal{T}}$ consists of all $\pi \geq 0$ that satisfy the 6 conditions above.

MTO Example: Sharp Bounds on $\pi_{[(\cdot, M)]}$

For the MTO example considered earlier, the following bounds are sharp

$$\max \left\{ \int_{\mathcal{Y}} \max \left\{ 0, \mathbf{p}\mathbf{f}_{M|Z=(1,1)}(y) - \mathbf{p}\mathbf{f}_{M|Z=(0,0)}(y) \right\} d\mu(y), \right. \\ \left. \mathbf{p}_H[(0,1)] - \mathbf{p}_H[(1,1)] \int_{\mathcal{Y}} \max \left\{ 0, \mathbf{p}\mathbf{f}_{L|Z=(0,0)}(y) - \mathbf{p}\mathbf{f}_{L|Z=(1,1)}(y) \right\} d\mu(y) \right\}$$

$$\leq \pi_{(HHM)} + \pi_{(HLM)} + \pi_{(LLM)} \leq$$

$$\min \left\{ \mathbf{p}_M[(1,1)] - \mathbf{p}_M[(0,1)], \right. \\ \left. \mathbf{p}_M[(1,1)] - \mathbf{p}_M[(0,0)] + \int_{\mathcal{Y}} \min \left\{ \mathbf{p}\mathbf{f}_{L|Z=(1,1)}(y), \mathbf{p}\mathbf{f}_{L|Z=(0,1)}(y) - \mathbf{p}\mathbf{f}_{L|Z=(0,0)}(y) \right\} d\mu(y) \right\}$$

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